CAMP CELEBRATE'S

Family Guide

YOUR FAMILY'S GUIDE TO CAMP CELEBRATE



www.luke14ministries.net

WELCOME TO

CAMP CELEBRATE 2025







What is Camp Celebrate?

Camp Celebrate offers respite to families affected by disability through Christ-centered activities and relationships. At Camp Celebrate, individuals with disabilities and their families receive care and encouragement in a safe camp environment. Located at Carson Springs Baptist Conference Center in Newport, Tennessee, the camp provides lodging, three meals daily, fully accessible activities, and a supportive atmosphere. Families leave camp feeling refreshed, encouraged, and likely a bit tired from all the fun!

WHAT IS CAMP CELEBRATE CONT..

We call Camp Celebrate a Family Retreat because it offers families affected by disability a chance to escape their daily routines. It's designed for all ages, ensuring that every camper feels welcomed and celebrated.

The schedule includes family activities, large group teaching and worship, free time for children, and refreshing and encouraging times for parents to connect with others on similar journeys. Age-appropriate programs ensure fun and safety for every camper.

Each family member with a disability is paired with a STM (Short Term Missionary) from 8:00 am to 9:00 pm. These STMs support and care for their assigned camper and family. However, STMs cannot assist with personal needs, so families should arrange for any required help, such as diaper changes.

MESSAGE FROM DARLENE

WHY WE DO WHAT WE DO



Before we get any further with our details, you need to know two things: first, organizing a “Camp Celebrate” is a lot of work, a huge responsibility, and requires an army of volunteers. Second, it is worth it. The first time I experienced Family Retreat was with Joni and Friends in 2002. I cried the whole week. I had never seen so much pain, brokenness, disability, and dysfunction in one place. But, amazingly, during that week, I began to see the face and heart of God more clearly than ever before. Spending a week at Family Retreat can be life-changing for both volunteers and families. Many people arrive feeling

totally alone and exhausted. As volunteers come alongside them and offer support and friendship, they begin to stand up straighter. As families meet and share stories, their hearts are bound together, realizing they are not alone. Isolation and loneliness can strangle hope, but at Camp Celebrate, the light dawns again.

Jesus came to fulfill Isaiah 61. He preached good news to the poor, bound up broken hearts, set captives free, and brought prisoners out of darkness. He proclaimed that God loves us and will one day defeat what is wrong in the world. He comforted and provided for those who have suffered loss, and then He told us to follow Him. This is our command and our opportunity to reach out and minister in His name to a world that is hemorrhaging out of control.

As we show the hurting that we care, come alongside them, and help bear their burdens and bind up their wounds, we fulfill the calling of Christ, and they are better able to believe that He is with them and loves them.

This is Kingdom work and is worthy of our sacrifice. It will bless you beyond what you can even imagine—I promise.



DAILY ACTIVITIES

CRAFTS & ACTIVITIES

for your family

Pontoon Boats

Rides depart from Swan's Marina, about a half-hour drive from Camp Carson. Families should be aware that the walk to the marina is quite long and plan to transport family members with mobility impairments in wheelchairs. The rides typically last around 30 to 45 minutes, following the sign-up schedule.

White Water Rafting

A 20-minute drive from camp, take I-40 East to the Hartford exit – Exit 447. The address is Smoky Mountain River Rat Whitewater, 3630 Hartford Road, Hartford, TN 37753. Including orientation, loading the boats, and an hour to float down the river, allow at least 3 hours.

Paintball

Run by Carson Springs staff on appointed days. Wheelchairs can only use the lower Speed Ball court as it is on flatter ground.

Crafts

A variety of craft projects are offered in Carson Hall on Tuesday through Thursday afternoons.

Climbing wall

This activity is run by Carson Springs staff on scheduled days. They are trained and qualified to safely help anyone climb the wall, including those without sufficient strength of their own.

Pool

Open every day, depending on weather and schedule. There is a small hydraulic lift to help people get in and out of the water. A lifeguard is on duty at all times.

Archery

Run by Carson Springs staff on appointed days.

LODGING AT

CAMP CELEBRATE

for your family





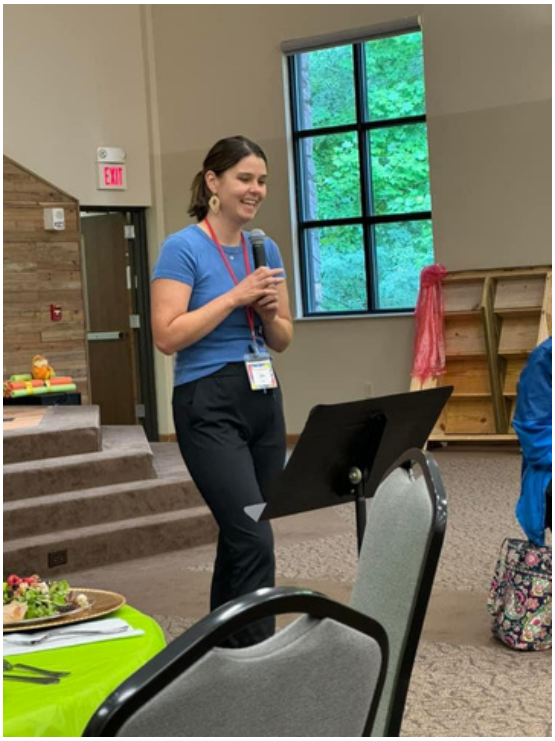
You and your family will stay together in the lodge, which features hotel-style rooms with two double beds each. If you need additional beds, a limited number of rollaways are available. Each room includes a private bathroom.

Please note: The rooms do not have TVs, so you may want to bring activities or devices for downtime. Additionally, bringing a sound machine can be super helpful in creating a peaceful sleeping environment.

If you require a second room, please contact us at **camp@luke14ministries.net** to discuss your specific needs. We are happy to explore other accommodations if necessary.

Carson Springs













MEALS AT

CAMP CELEBRATE

for your family

All meals will be provided during Camp. Most meals will be served in a cafeteria setting by a mix of volunteers and Carson Springs staff. If you have any allergies or dietary preferences, please let us know in advance so we can accommodate your needs.

During meals, your camper's buddy will join you to enjoy a family-style meal and fellowship. There are a few occasions when caregivers will eat separately, and the buddies will accompany the campers for their meals. However, most meals will be enjoyed together as a group.

Feel free to bring any snacks you may want to enjoy between breakfast, lunch, and dinner. Additionally, some families find it helpful to bring a blender they are familiar with, especially for preparing special dietary items or smoothies.

WHAT TO BRING TO CAMP

Packing List

- Beach towels
- Money for camp store*
- Bible, notebook, pen
- Bug spray, sunscreen
- Casual, comfortable clothing
- Shoes comfortable for walking around camp
- Water shoes (for whitewater rafting)
- Modest, full coverage bathing suit
- Toiletries and other personal items
- Jacket
- Camping chair(s) with your name on them
- Camera
- Special food or medical equipment needed
- Medication

DAY 1

WELCOME

Sample Schedule

Day 1: Arrival and Welcome

1:00-3:00 PM | Arrival

We're so excited to welcome you to Camp Celebrate! Expect a grand entrance like no other. Our amazing volunteers will be waiting with colorful signs, dressed to match the theme, and ready to cheer as your camper arrives.

If your camper is sensitive to noise or large crowds, don't worry—we're happy to provide a quieter, more sensory-friendly arrival experience.

3:00-4:00 PM | Settle Into Camp

Upon arrival, your camper's buddy will meet you and your family to help you settle in. They'll assist with unloading, give you a tour of the camp, and ensure you have everything you need to feel comfortable. They're also happy to take your camper for a walk or engage them in fun activities while you get organized.

5:00 PM | Welcome Assembly

Kick off Camp Celebrate with our welcome assembly! Join us as we gather together for worship songs, meet our camp director, and hear an exciting overview of the week's activities.

6:00 PM | Dinner

Enjoy dinner in a welcoming, family-style cafeteria setting. If you have specific dietary needs, let us know during enrollment so we can accommodate you.

7:00 PM | Welcome Party

It's time to celebrate! We believe the kingdom of God should feel like a joyful party. The welcome party will feature music, dancing, games, entertainment, and plenty of fellowship. It's the perfect way to start the week!



DAY 2

Sample Schedule

8:00–9:00 AM | Breakfast

Start your day with breakfast in the cafeteria, prepared by our wonderful Carson Springs staff.

9:00–10:00 AM | Morning Assembly

Gather with your fellow campers and families for a morning assembly filled with worship, encouragement, and updates on the day's activities.

10:00 AM–12:00 PM | Morning Programming

Dive into the fun! Morning programming includes engaging activities like crafts, outdoor adventures, group games, and more. Each activity is designed to foster connection, joy, and inclusion.

12:00 PM | Lunch

Refuel with a hearty meal in the cafeteria, surrounded by friends, family, and buddies.

1:00–4:00 PM | Afternoon Programming

The afternoon continues with exciting programming tailored to your camper's interests. Activities may include horseback riding, sensory-friendly options, or even a chance to explore nature with their buddy.

4:00–5:00 PM | Buddy Break & Family Hour

During this hour, your STM buddy gets a well-deserved break, while families have time to relax and reconnect. This is a great opportunity for quiet time, a family walk, or just enjoying the beautiful camp surroundings.

5:00 PM | Dinner

Enjoy another wonderful meal together in the cafeteria. Special dietary accommodations are available to ensure everyone feels included.

6:00 PM | Group Photo

7:00 PM | Dance & Camp Activitie

Get ready for an evening of fun! Activities might include a camp-wide game, a talent show, or themed group events that bring everyone together.

10:00 PM | Lights Out

After a full day of excitement, it's time to rest up for another amazing day ahead.

“Go out quickly into the streets and alleys of the town and bring in the poor, the crippled, the blind and the lame.”

Luke 14:21

